

Mobile watch

Among other things we check out Facebook's attempt at deep integration on the Android platform via Home

App watch

This time around we check out six apps to keep you up to date with the IPL fever this season

Contemplating the Logosphere

Since we last met, we've seen quite a few changes to the World Wide Web, from popular websites abandoning their tried-and-tested business models, to a new search engine that can sniff out vulnerable connected devices ranging from cyclotrons to routers

Flipkart Marketplace to take on eBay

Online retailer Flipkart is looking to change its business model as it recently announced a new marketplace system. Dubbed as Flipkart Marketplace, the new system is said to transform the site into a "virtual mall" and provide customers access to various sellers and brands on one platform.

Moreover, users will be able to compare sellers and get the best prices at varied service levels for most products. Flipkart will also be introducing categories such as clothes, shoes among others. The new business model of Flipkart, believed to be inspired from eBay and Amazon, indicates the company will no longer have an inventory of its own.

Flipkart in a release explained what the new system brings in for users as well as sellers. The company says users will continue to enjoy COD/EMI options and return/replacement policies. One of the important highlights of the new system is

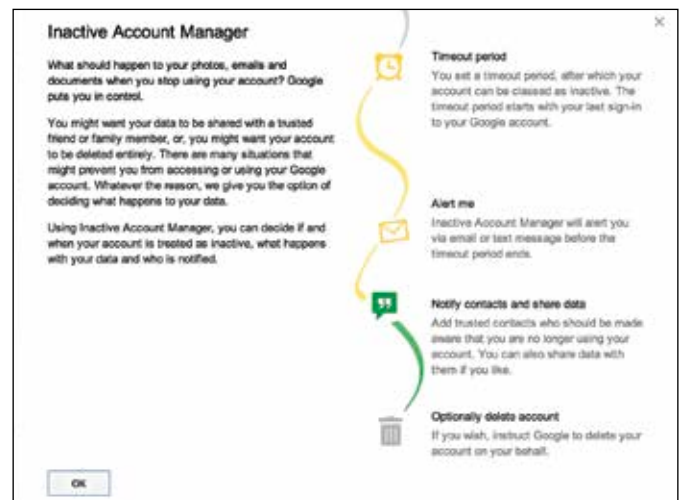
that Flipkart will continue to take care of shipping and door-step delivery through its logistics partners. A new protection programme will be formed to resolve complaints.

For sellers, Flipkart says it will bring in a "rigorous onboarding process" for identifying the sellers and to ensure sale of genuine products. Sellers who provide a superior customer experience will get prominence on Flipkart Marketplace. Flipkart further says the new system will encourage the SME community.

Google Inactive Account Manager

Lately, there has been a lot of concern over what happens to one's emails and social networking profiles after their passing. Google has launched the Inactive Account Manager, which allows you to control what happens to your Google accounts after you pass away.

The tool, announced in a Public Policy Blog post entitled



Google Inactive Account Manager

'Plan your digital afterlife with Inactive Account Manager,' gives the user several ways to tackle the issue of wiping their Google Digital Footprint. The first involves sending a text message to a phone number after a set amount of time has passed. You can select up to ten contacts who will receive your Google account log-in information after a long amount of time has passed from your last log-in.

If giving away your account information gets you queasy even in the afterlife, then there is always the "self-destruct" option. If your account hasn't seen you logging in for a considerable amount of time, then Google will just delete your entire account completely.

SHODAN Strikes Again

PC gamers who played System Shock 2 will recall the creepy

disembodied A.I. SHODAN that made their lives hell in the game. Taking inspiration from that, computer engineer John Matherley, created the Shodan search engine, a search engine that can find a huge number of devices connected to the Internet – from servers to webcams and routers. According to a CNN story, a large number of the connected devices that Shodan turns up are unprotected and can be accessed by almost anyone with an Internet connection.

This is scary because along with stuff like home routers and office printers, Shodan search results have also turned up command and control systems for a nuclear plant, traffic lights and even a particle accelerator cyclotron, which sounds like something that Bruce Banner would accidentally set off. Searching for connected devices on Shodan also



Flipkart Marketplace user interface